

Weekly Theta Shortlist — September 7, 2026

Window: Run date Sept 7, 2026. 50-day earnings-free window closes Oct 27, 2026. Names reporting on or before that date are excluded.

Regime this week

VIX 16.34 — calm on a spot basis but ~45th historical percentile and +12.6% over 3 months. The dominant risk is next week's FOMC (Sept 15–16): markets are pricing ~65% odds of a 25bp **hike**, a credibility move against sticky oil-driven inflation (Brent ~\$94, up ~\$25 YoY on Strait-of-Hormuz supply frictions). Every 45 DTE position opened this week carries FOMC at ~30 DTE and Q3 earnings peaks (mid-Oct to mid-Nov) at ~25–40 DTE. Bias: favor defined-risk credit spreads over naked short options; \$120 oil tail keeps energy IV rich and the tape hawkish.

FLAG: Consensus shifted from 'hold through 2026' to 'hike next week' in a matter of days. A hawkish surprise (50bp) or dovish walk-back both produce large single-day moves. Consider holding new size until after the Sept 16 close.

Tier A — late-Nov / Dec reporters (cleanest 45 DTE window; next earnings 21+ days past window close)

#	Ticker	Sector	Mkt Cap	Est. IV band	Est. HV band	Weeklies	Next Earnings	Days	Justification
1	WMT	Consumer Staples	~\$780bn	~20-26%	~18-24%	Yes	Nov 19, 2026	73	Q2 FY27 reported Aug 21. Deep option liquidity, penny-wide chains, IV usually mid-20s outside prints. Consumer-defensive tilt against a hawkish Fed. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>
2	HD	Consumer Discretionary	~\$400bn	~22-28%	~20-26%	Yes	Nov 17, 2026	71	Q2 FY26 reported Aug 19. Rate-sensitive (housing / reno demand) — a 25bp hike is a partial headwind and helps keep IV in the sweet spot. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>
3	TGT	Consumer Discretionary	~\$65bn	~30-38%	~28-36%	Yes	Nov 18, 2026	72	Q2 2026 reported Aug 19. Higher-IV consumer-discretionary print; richer premium than WMT/HD but wider idio range. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>
4	DE	Industrials	~\$150bn	~25-32%	~22-30%	Yes	Nov 25, 2026	79	Q4 FY26 print late Nov — longest confirmed runway on the list. FY Oct year-end. Brazil / large-ag exposure is the idio risk. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>
5	MDT	Health Care	~\$115bn	~20-26%	~18-24%	Yes	Nov 18-27, 2026 (est)	72-81	Q1 FY27 reported Sep 1. Defensive med-tech; low correlation to macro shock. Date unconfirmed — MarketChameleon estimate; verify IR when posted. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>
6	INTU	Tech (non-semi)	~\$180bn	~26-34%	~24-32%	Yes	Nov 19-23, 2026 (est)	73-77	Q1 FY27 reported Aug 25. Tax-cycle predictability; higher IV than staples without semi cyclicity. Date unconfirmed — verify IR when posted. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>
7	CRM	Tech (non-semi)	~\$310bn	~26-34%	~24-32%	Yes	Dec 2-4, 2026 (est)	86-88	Q2 FY27 reported Aug 26 (+22.6% next day). Longest runway on list. Idio tail on gen-AI monetization narrative. Date unconfirmed. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>

Tier B — early-November reporters (~2 weeks past window close; watch for date drift)

#	Ticker	Sector	Mkt Cap	Est. IV band	Est. HV band	Weeklies	Next Earnings	Days	Justification
1	CSCO	Tech (non-semi)	~\$225bn	~22-28%	~20-26%	Yes	Nov 12, 2026 (est)	66	Q4 FY26 reported Aug 12 (-8.4% next day). Q1 FY27 date pattern-only (MarketChameleon; not IR-confirmed). Oct 22 expiry sits ~3 weeks before print, acceptable, but exit if IR announces an earlier date. Date unconfirmed. <i>Verify at IBKR.</i>

Changes vs last week

First run — no comparison.

Excluded this week (with reason)

- **AVGO, MU, NVDA, AMD, INTC, AMAT, LRCX, KLAC, MRVL** — semis — excluded by universe rule.
- **TSLA, COIN, MSTR, PLTR** — high-beta / meme — excluded by universe rule.
- **NFLX** — IV typically >40% outside of prints.
- **NKE, FDX, ORCL, ADBE, COST** — earnings inside 50-day window (Sept reports).
- **JPM, BAC, GS, MS, WFC, C** — Q3 earnings mid-Oct — inside window.
- **XOM, CVX, COP** — energy IV likely >40% given oil regime; Q3 also inside window.
- **BA, CAT, GE, LMT, NOC, GD, RTX** — earnings late-Oct — inside window.
- **V, MA** — Q3 earnings inside window.
- **PG, KO, PEP, MCD, PM, MDLZ** — IV typically below 20% band.
- **JNJ, PFE, MRK, ABBV, LLY** — most report inside window; LLY IV likely >40%.
- **TJX, ROST, LOW** — likely Nov 15–20 reporters (would be Tier A candidates) but exact date not confirmed by two sources this run — dropped rather than guessed.
- **BABA, JD** — Chinese ADR overhang inconsistent with baseline exclusion logic.

Sizing note for this week

FOMC lands Sept 15–16 at ~30 DTE from a 45 DTE open — the dominant event risk in every position opened this week. Weight cash-secured 10–12 delta puts on the confirmed-date Nov reporters (**WMT, HD, DE**) at 60–70% of normal short-premium size; use 10–15 / 6–9 credit spreads on the higher-IV names (**TGT, INTU, CRM**) to cap the tail. Cap consumer discretionary (HD + TGT) at one full allocation slot — they share the housing/rate story. Skip strangles this week: gamma into an FOMC surprise with \$120 oil tail risk is not where 3%/month comes from. **CSCO** is a reach-for-yield sleeve only — the unconfirmed print date is a real risk if it drifts inside window.

Verify at IBKR before trading

Every row above needs live confirmation of: 13w and 26w IV percentile > 50; IV in 20–40% band; HV in 20–40% band; IV/HV between 100% and 150%; no unreported earnings amendment. This list is a filtered starting universe, not a completed screen.

Sources

1. VIX level and trend — regime baseline — <https://www.macroradar.io/vix>
2. FOMC September 2026 expectations — 25bp hike probability, energy-shock context — <https://www.chase.com/personal/investments/learning-and-insights/article/september-2026-rate-hike-now-expected-amid-energy-shocks>
3. Oil price early September 2026 — Brent \$94, Strait-of-Hormuz context — <https://fortune.com/article/price-of-oil-09-01-2026/>
4. FOMC schedule — Sept 15–16 — <https://fdratecalc.com/fomc-meeting-schedule/>

5. WMT Q3 FY27 date — Nov 19, 2026 (primary IR) — <https://corporate.walmart.com/news/events/fy2027-q3-earnings-release>
6. HD Q3 2026 date — Nov 17, 2026 (Wall Street Horizon) — <https://www.wallstreethorizon.com/home-depot-earnings-calendar>
7. TGT Q3 2026 date — Nov 18, 2026 (primary IR) — <https://corporate.target.com/investors/events-presentations>
8. DE Q4 FY26 date — Nov 25, 2026 (Quartr, from IR) — https://quartr.com/companies/deere-company_5855
9. CSCO Q4 FY26 results release — Aug 12, 2026 (primary IR); Q1 FY27 date inferred — <https://investor.cisco.com/news/news-details/2026/CISCO-REPORTS-FOURTH-QUARTER-AND-FISCAL-YEAR-2026-EARNINGS/default.aspx>
10. CSCO Q1 FY27 estimate — Nov 12, 2026 — <https://marketchameleon.com/Overview/CSCO/Earnings/Earnings-Dates/>
11. CRM Q3 FY27 estimate — Dec 2–4, 2026 — <https://marketchameleon.com/Overview/CRM/Earnings/Earnings-Dates/>
12. INTU Q1 FY27 estimate — Nov 19–23, 2026 — <https://marketchameleon.com/Overview/INTU/Earnings/Earnings-Dates/>
13. MDT Q2 FY27 estimate — Nov 18–27, 2026 — <https://marketchameleon.com/Overview/MDT/Earnings/Earnings-Dates/>
14. LOW IR page (no Q3 2026 date published yet — used to confirm absence) — <https://corporate.lowes.com/investors/financial-information/quarterly-earnings/year/2026>
15. Home Depot Q2 FY26 transcript / date pattern — <https://seekingalpha.com/article/4845121-the-home-depot-inc-hd-q3-2026-earnings-call-transcript>
16. Lowe's WebFetch attempt (Nasdaq): data currently unavailable — source unreachable, flagged — <https://www.nasdaq.com/market-activity/stocks/low/earnings>
17. CNBC market-day live update Sept 2, 2026 — single-stock scan (403; not usable this run) — <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/09/02/stock-market-today-live-updates.html>